



User Manual & Strategy Guide: Vocab Vortex (PRO)

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Target Audience: Teachers, Parents, & Independent Learners

Format: Browser-based Retro Arcade Game (Typing & Spelling)



What is Vocab Vortex?

Vocab Vortex is a "Gamified Flashcard Engine."

Most vocabulary apps force you to use *their* words. Vocab Vortex is different because it includes a **Custom Database Engine**. This means you can take **ANY** list of words—from a textbook, a school spelling list, or a business English article—and turn it into an exciting video game in seconds.



FOR PARENTS: "The Friday Spelling Test Hack"

Does your child hate studying for spelling tests? Do they find rewriting words on paper boring?

How to use this game at home:

1. **Get the List:** Take the weekly spelling list your child brought home from school.
2. **Input:** Open the game, select " **Custom List**", and type those specific words into the box.
3. **Save:** Click "**Quick Save**". Now the game remembers them.
4. **The Routine:** Have your child play for **10 minutes** before dinner.
 - *Why it works:* The game refuses to destroy the asteroid unless the word is typed correctly. It forces them to fix their spelling errors instantly, which builds memory much faster than just reading.

Recommended Mode: Use **Spelling Mode** (typing letters) on a computer for maximum retention.



FOR INDEPENDENT LEARNERS: "The Polyglot Drill"

Are you learning English on your own? (Or preparing for IELTS/TOEFL?)

Use Vocab Vortex to "force" memorization of difficult words.

The "High-Speed" Drill Strategy:

1. **Curate:** Find a list of "Top 50 TOEFL Words" or words you constantly forget.
2. **Load:** Paste them into the game.
3. **Intensity:** Set the speed slider to **4 or 5 (Fast)**.
4. **Play:** Keep playing until you can clear the board without losing a life.
 - *Why it works:* High speed forces your brain to stop translating in your head and start recognizing words by sight (Automaticity).



HOW TO USE: The Custom List Feature

This is the "Killer Feature" for your classroom.

1. Create Your Own List

1. Open the game.
2. In the "Database" panel, select " **Custom List**".
3. Type your words into the text box (one word per line).
4. Click "**Quick Save**" to store it in the browser for next time.

2. Homework Strategy (Import/Export Workflow)

This feature allows you to send "Game Levels" to your students as homework files.

The Workflow:

1. **Teacher:** Types the weekly vocabulary list into the game.
2. **Teacher:** Clicks "**Export File**". This downloads a .txt file (e.g., Unit_1_Vocab.txt).
3. **Distribution:** Upload this .txt file to Google Classroom, Seesaw, or email it to students along with the game link/file.
4. **Student:** Opens the game at home → Clicks "**Import File**" → Selects the .txt file.
5. **Result:** The game instantly updates to use *only* those words for their session.



Homework & Remote Learning Ideas

Here are three specific ways to use this tool for homework:

1. The Weekly Challenge (Drilling)

- **Task:** Send students the exported file for the week's spelling list.
- **Goal:** They must play until they achieve a score of 3,000 points on "Normal" speed.
- **Proof:** Students take a screenshot of their "Mission Failed" or High Score screen and upload it to your LMS.

2. "Beat the Teacher" (Motivation)

- **Task:** Record yourself playing a specific list (e.g., scoring 5,000 points).
- **Challenge:** Send the list file to students. Challenge them to beat your high score over the weekend.

- **Reward:** The student with the highest score gets a privilege in class (e.g., choosing the music).

3. Student Creators (Reverse Engineering)

- **Task:** Instead of *you* making the list, ask students to create a "Review Level."
- **Action:** Students open the game, type in 10 words they found difficult from the textbook, and click "**Export File**".
- **Submission:** They send *their* file to you. You can then use these student-generated lists for a class tournament.



Classroom Activity Ideas

1. "The Hot Seat" (Projector Mode)

- **Setup:** Teacher computer connected to projector.
- **Input:** Wireless Keyboard passed around the room.
- **Task:** The student in the "Hot Seat" must type the words to defend the ship. The rest of the class shouts the spelling ("A! P! P! L! E!") to help them.

2. "Tablet Team Race" (iPad/Chromebook)

- **Setup:** Students in pairs with one device.
- **Mode:** Use the **On-Screen Number Pad**.
- **Task:** Student A holds the device. Student B calls out the answer (e.g., "Number 3 is Lion!"). Student A taps 3.
- **Why?** It forces communication and teamwork.

3. "The Spelling Bee Tournament" (Computer Lab)

- **Setup:** Individual devices.
- **Rule:** "You CANNOT use the number keys. You must TYPE every word."
- **Challenge:** Who can survive the longest on "Fast" speed using only typing?



CONTROLS & MODES

1. Dual-Input System (New!)

The game works on Computers, Tablets, and Phones automatically.

- **Spelling Mode (Keyboard):** Type the letters (L-I-O-N). Best for learning spelling accuracy.
- **Rapid Mode (Number Keys):** Press the number shown on the asteroid (1-9). Best for testing reading speed on tablets/iPads.

2. Custom List Features

- **Quick Save:** Remembers your list in *this* browser on *this* device.
- **Export/Import:** Allows you to move lists between devices or share them with others.

3. Warp Speed Slider

- **Left (Slow):** Best for long, complex words (e.g., "Congratulations").
- **Right (Extreme):** Best for short sight words (e.g., "The", "And", "Was").

TROUBLESHOOTING

"I typed the word but it didn't explode!"

- Did you mistype a letter? Look at the asteroid—correct letters turn **GREEN**.
- Did you leave an empty space after the word in your list? (The game trims these automatically, but check your list just in case).

"Where is the sound?"

- Browsers block sound until you interact with the page. Click the **"START GAME"** button to activate the audio engine.

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